PEW RESEARCH CENTER
July 26-29, 2012 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,010

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
July 26-29, 2012	32	30	20	19	*
July 19-22, 2012	39	29	16	16	*
July 12-15, 2012	32	33	18	17	1
July 5-8, 2012	34	28	18	19	1
June 28-July 1, 2012	38	28	15	18	1
June 21-24, 2012	33	32	17	17	*
June 14-17, 2012	39	28	15	17	*
June 7-10, 2012	35	32	15	18	*
May 31-June 3, 2012	37	34	13	14	1
May 24-27, 2012	33	31	19	16	1
May 17-20, 2012	35	30	16	19	*
May 10-13, 2012	40	26	16	17	*
May 3-6, 2012	38	29	13	20	*
April 26-29, 2012	34	32	17	16	1
April 19-22, 2012	35	35	13	14	2
April 12-15, 2012	39	28	16	17	1
April 5-8, 2012	37	31	16	16	1
March 29-April 1, 2012	34	33	15	18	1
March 22-25, 2012	36	29	16	18	1
March 15-18, 2012	40	35	11	14	1
March 8-11, 2012	37	32	14	17	*
March 1-4, 2012	41	27	15	17	1
February 23-26, 2012	37	33	14	15	1
February 16-20, 2012	33	32	16	17	1
February 9-12, 2012	42	30	14	13	1
February 2-5, 2012	38	32	16	13	1
January 26-29, 2012	35	31	16	19	*
January 19-22, 2012	35	30	16	19	1
January 12-15, 2012	33	32	14	20	1
January 5-8, 2012	39	31	15	15	*
December 15-18, 2011	36	32	14	16	1
December 8-11, 2011	41	29	13	16	1
December 1-4, 2011	40	33	13	13	1
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Economy-Trends.pdf

b. The start of the Summer Olympics in London					
July 26-29, 2012	19	25	25	31	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
February 26-March 1, 2010: *The Winter Olympics in Vancouver, Canada*	23	28	28	21	*
February 19-22, 2010	30	25	19	25	*
February 12-15, 2010: *The start of the Winter Olympics in Vancouver, Canada*	18	23	23	35	1
Aug 22-25, 2008: *The Olympic Games in Beijing, China*	35	31	19	15	*
August 15-18, 2008	35	31	17	16	1
August 8-11, 2008	24	29	24	23	*
August 1-4, 2008[1]	13	33	31	23	*
July 25-28, 2008	12	31	29	28	*
April 4-7, 2008	5	18	31	45	1
Early September, 2004: *Summer/Athens*	25	25	21	29	*
February 12-18, 2002: *Winter/Utah*	22	30	21	26	1
Early October, 2000: *Summer/Sydney*	27	28	24	21	*
Early September, 1996: *Summer/Atlanta*	32	34	20	14	*
July, 1996: *Summer/Atlanta*	45	30	13	11	1
February, 1992: *Winter/France*	33	30	19	17	1
c. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential election					
July 26-29, 2012	25	28	21	25	1
July 19-22, 2012	35	22	17	25	1

[1] For August 1-4, 2008 and April 4-7, 2008 the story was listed as "News about the upcoming Olympic games in Beijing, China." For July 25-28, 2008 the story was listed as "News about China as the Beijing Olympic Games approach."

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July 12-15, 2012	33	24	20	23	*
July 5-8, 2012	29	26	20	25	*
June 28-July 1, 2012	32	24	19	25	*
June 21-24, 2012	27	30	17	25	1
June 14-17, 2012	31	30	15	24	*
June 7-10, 2012	30	29	16	25	1
May 31-June 3, 2012	29	28	19	23	1
May 24-27, 2012	32	28	16	24	1
May 17-20, 2012	31	26	19	23	*
May 10-13, 2012	34	23	18	24	*
May 3-6, 2012	29	27	19	24	*
April 26-29, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
April 19-22, 2012	29	29	20	20	1
April 12-15, 2012	32	28	16	23	1
April 5-8, 2012	31	27	18	23	*
March 29-April 1, 2012	23	29	21	27	*
March 22-25, 2012	28	28	18	25	1
March 15-18, 2012	28	31	17	24	*
March 8-11, 2012	28	27	21	23	*
March 1-4, 2012	31	24	20	24	1
February 23-26, 2012	28	29	18	24	1
February 16-20, 2012	25	29	19	25	2
February 9-12, 2012	35	25	18	20	1
February 2-5, 2012	30	27	20	21	1
January 26-29, 2012	28	30	21	21	1
January 19-22, 2012	28	30	17	24	*
January 12-15, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
January 5-8, 2012	29	30	16	25	*
December 15-18, 2011	26	24	20	29	1
December 8-11, 2011	27	27	18	28	*
December 1-4, 2011	25	28	20	26	1
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Election-Trends.pdf

d. The shooting at a movie theater near Denver, Colorado					
July 26-29, 2012	41	33	16	9	1
July 20-22, 2012[2]	48	25	15	11	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
April 5-8, 2012: *A shooting at a small college in Oakland, California, that killed seven people*	21	28	25	25	2
March 1-4, 2012: *A deadly school shooting near Cleveland*	26	31	22	19	1
December 8-11, 2011: *Deadly shootings at Virginia Tech University*	20	27	29	24	1
August 7-10, 2011: *A shooting at a fitness club in Pennsylvania*	13	28	25	34	1
June 12-15, 2009: *A deadly shooting at the Holocaust Memorial Museum in Washington, D.C.*	26	34	17	23	*
January 13-16, 2011: *News about a Congresswoman and others shot in Tucson, Arizona*	49	28	12	11	1
April 3-6, 2009: *A shooter killing several people at an immigration services center in Binghamton, New York*	26	32	19	23	*
March 13-16, 2009: *A shooting spree in Alabama that resulted in the death of 11 people*	18	33	24	25	*
February 15-18, 2008: *The shootings at Northern Illinois University that resulted in the death of 7 people*	26	40	19	15	0
February 8-11, 2008: *A shooting at a city council meeting in Missouri where six people were killed*	13	28	25	33	1
December 14-17, 2007: *Shootings at two religious centers in Colorado*	17	31	24	27	1
December 7-10, 2007: *A shooting at a shopping mall in Omaha, Nebraska where eight people were killed*	30	36	18	15	1
October 12-15, 2007: *The shooting at a high school in Cleveland, Ohio*	22	32	25	20	1
April 20-23, 2007: *The shootings at Virginia Tech University that resulted in the death of 33 people*	45	37	13	5	*
October, 2006: *Recent shootings at schools in Pennsylvania and other states*	46	33	12	8	1
March, 2000: *The shooting of a 6-year-old girl at a Michigan school*	40	38	15	7	*
September, 1999: *The shootings in a Jewish community center in Los Angeles*	29	34	22	14	1

[2] Item was asked from July 20-22, 2012 only. N=780.

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
Late April, 1999: *The shooting of students and teachers by two students at a Colorado high school*	68	24	6	2	*
June, 1998: *The shooting at a high school in Springfield, Oregon*	46	36	14	4	*
March, 1998: *The shooting at a middle school in Jonesboro, Arkansas*	49	33	12	5	1

ASK ALL:
Thinking about the shooting in Colorado last week…
PEW.2 Do you think this shooting reflects broader problems in American society, or are things like this just the isolated acts of troubled individuals?

July 26-29 2012		**TRENDS FOR COMPARISON** Jan 13-16 2011[3]	Apr 18-22 2007
24	Broader problems	31	46
67	Isolated acts	58	47
8	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	12	7

ASK ALL:
On a different subject,
PEWWP.1 How much, if anything, have you heard about increased spending in this year's presidential election by outside groups not associated with the candidates or campaigns? **[READ]**

July 26-29 2012	
25	A lot
36	A little [OR]
39	Nothing at all
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

[3] January, 2011 question asked about the shooting in Tucson, Arizona. April, 2007 question was asked after the shooting at Virginia Tech and asked about "this shooting and others like it."

ASK ALL:

PEWWP.2 What do you think the main effect of this increased spending by outside groups will be on the election? **[OPEN END, ACCEPT UP TO TWO RESPONSES. DO NOT PROBE FOR ADDITIONAL RESPONSES]**

BASED ON FIRST RESPONSE ONLY

July 26-29 2012	
24	Negative reaction NET
5	Corrupt electoral process/biased election/buy election/favors who has most money
4	Bad/negative/annoying/against it
2	Too much money/money source unknown/waste of money/overspending
2	Negatively influence voters/repress voter turnout/skew outcome
2	Unfair advantage for special interests/benefit media, corporations, rich
1	More negative ads/propaganda
1	Change things/impact things in a bad way
1	Misleading/false information/confusion
1	Will increase taxes/debt/deficit
1	Takes money from other things/should go elsewhere
1	Hurt job growth/hurt economy
4	Other
2	Positive reaction NET
1	Change things/impact things in a good way/encourage voting
1	Other
27	Neutral reaction NET
7	Not change things/little impact or difference/not change those with minds made up
6	Change things/impact things/chance voters or election
1	Benefit Romney/benefit Republicans/benefit conservatives
1	A lot/ a lot more
1	More ads
1	Help both sides/depends on side spending/who has the money
1	None/nothing
10	Other
48	No opinion

ASK ALL:

PEWWP.3 And just in general, do you think increased spending by outside groups in the presidential election will **[RANDOMIZE OPTIONS 1 AND 2 WITH 3 ALWAYS LAST]**

July 26-29 2012	
15	Help Obama more than Romney
16	Help Romney more than Obama [OR]
51	Not help one candidate more than the other
18	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

NO QUESTIONS PEW.3-PEW.9

ASK ALL:
Next I'd like to ask about some things that have been in the news. Please answer as best you can. If you don't know the answer just tell me and we'll move to the next question.

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.10 Which presidential candidate is PRO-LIFE, that is, supports restricting access to abortion in most cases? **[RANDOMIZE OPTIONS 1 AND 2 FIRST, WITH OPTIONS 3 AND 4 FOLLOWING IN ORDER]**

July 26-29, 2012[4]

GP	*RV*	
14	13	Obama
47	54	Romney (correct)
7	6	Both
9	9	Neither
23	18	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.11 Which presidential candidate supports allowing many illegal immigrants who were brought to the U.S. as children to remain in the country? **[RANDOMIZE OPTIONS 1 AND 2 FIRST, WITH OPTIONS 3 AND 4 FOLLOWING IN ORDER]**

July 26-29, 2012

GP	*RV*	
63	66	Obama (correct)
2	1	Romney
9	10	Both
7	6	Neither
19	17	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.12 Which presidential candidate opposes allowing gays and lesbians to marry legally? **[RANDOMIZE OPTIONS 1 AND 2 FIRST, WITH OPTIONS 3 AND 4 FOLLOWING IN ORDER]**

July 26-29, 2012

GP	*RV*	
15	12	Obama
54	60	Romney (correct)
4	3	Both
10	11	Neither
18	14	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:
PEW.13 Which presidential candidate supports raising taxes on income over $250,000? **[RANDOMIZE OPTIONS 1 AND 2 FIRST, WITH OPTIONS 3 AND 4 FOLLOWING IN ORDER]**

July 26-29, 2012			July 12-15
GP	*RV*		2012
61	68	Obama (correct)	58
8	7	Romney	7
7	6	Both	7
5	4	Neither	8
19	15	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	20

[4] GP are numbers for general public, RV are numbers for registered voters. All trends are based on general public unless otherwise noted.

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.14 Was Mitt Romney governor of **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?

July 26-29, 2012			Jan 4-8
GP	*RV*		2012
53	60	Massachusetts (correct)	46
7	7	Utah	8
5	5	Michigan	5
4	3	Texas	6
30	25	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	36

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.15 Mitt Romney was the CEO of which of these companies…? **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?

July 26-29, 2012		
GP	*RV*	
53	61	Bain Capital (correct)
3	3	American Motors
3	2	Google
1	1	Sears
39	34	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.16 Do you happen to know which candidate in the 2008 election – Barack Obama or John McCain – received the most votes in the state you now live in?

July 26-29, 2012		
GP	*RV*	
53	52	Obama
21	25	McCain
25	23	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.17 Who is the current vice president of the United States? Is it… **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**

July 26-29, 2012		
GP	*RV*	
79	85	Joe Biden (correct)
4	3	Dick Cheney
3	3	Hillary Clinton
1	1	John Boehner
12	8	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

TREND FOR COMPARISION
Will you tell me who the Vice-President of the United States is? **[DO NOT READ]**

	-Dick/Richard Cheney-			**----Al Gore----**		**-Dan Quayle-**
	Feb	April	Mid-Nov	July	Feb	May
	2007	2002[5]	2001	1994	1994	1989
Yes, (correct)	69	61	67	65	70	74
Yes, names someone else	2	4	7	3	6	2
No, can't name the Vice President/DK/Ref	29	35	26	32	24	24
	100	100	100	100	100	100

[5] From April 2002 through February 1994 the question was worded: "Can you tell me the name of the current Vice-President of the United States?" In May 1989 the question was worded: "Will you tell me who the Vice-President of the United States is?"

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.18 Does the Republican Party currently have a majority of seats in… **[READ IN ORDER]**

July 26-29, 2012 GP	July 26-29, 2012 RV		*KN* Sep 30-Oct 11 2011[6]	Oct 6-9 2011	Mar 17-20 2011	Nov 11-14 2010
34	40	The House of Representatives (correct)	43	37	38	46
10	10	The Senate	15	8	11	8
12	13	Both the House and Senate	21	14	18	14
8	7	Neither the House nor the Senate	10	8	6	5
35	30	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	11	33	27	27

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.19 Do you happen to know who is the Chief Justice of the U.S. Supreme Court? Is it… **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?

July 26-29, 2012 GP	July 26-29, 2012 RV		Jul 1-5 2010	
34	39	John Roberts (correct)	28	John Roberts
1	1	Stephen Breyer	6	John Paul Stevens
12	12	William Rehnquist	8	Thurgood Marshall
3	3	Harry Reid	4	Harry Reid
51	45	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	53	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

TREND FOR COMPARISON

Hearst Corporation

Oct 20-Nov 2 1986[7]	
43	William Rehnquist
29	Warren Burger
7	Earl Warren
4	William Brennan, Jr.
16	DK/No answer

RANDOMIZE PEW.10 THROUGH PEW.20
ASK ALL:
PEW.20 What state did Barack Obama represent in the United States Senate, before he became president? **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?

July 26-29, 2012 GP	July 26-29, 2012 RV	
69	75	Illinois (correct)
2	1	New York
1	1	Texas
9	7	Hawaii
19	16	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

[6] Sep 30-Oct 11, 2011 survey conducted online by Knowledge Networks. Surveys from 2011, question read: "Thinking about Congress, do Republicans currently have a majority in …? For November 11-14, 2010, the question read: "When the new Congress convenes in January, will Republicans have a majority in…"

[7] For October 20-November 2, 1986, the Hearst Corporation question read: "Who is the current Chief Justice of the United States: William Rehnquist, Warren Burger, Earl Warren or William Brennan, Jr.?"

ASK ALL:
PEW.21 What does the term "super PAC" refer to **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?

July 26-29 2012	
40	A group able to accept unlimited political donations (correct)
4	Government clean-up projects at hazardous waste sites
9	A Congressional committee on the budget deficit
1	A popular video game for smartphones
46	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

NO QUESTIONS PEW.22-PEW.23

ASK ALL:
On a different subject,
PEW.24 What do you think is more important – to protect the right of Americans to own guns, OR to control gun ownership?

	Protect right to own guns	Control gun ownership	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July 26-29, 2012	46	47	6
Apr 4-15, 2012	49	45	6
Sep 22-Oct 4, 2011	47	49	5
Feb 22-Mar 1, 2011	48	47	6
Jan 13-16, 2011	49	46	6
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010	46	50	4
Mar 10-14, 2010	46	46	7
Mar 31-Apr 21, 2009	45	49	6
April, 2008	37	58	5
November, 2007	42	55	3
April, 2007	32	60	8
February, 2004	37	58	5
June, 2003	42	54	4
May, 2000	38	57	5
April, 2000	37	55	8
March, 2000	29	66	5
June, 1999	33	62	5
May, 1999	30	65	5
December, 1993	34	57	9